

MADRE manual

How to work with your AI agents

`MADRE 1.1.0`

In MADRE you work with the AIs you already use: Codex, Claude, Gemini, Cursor or OpenCode. You write to them as in a chat, they read your project, and you decide what they may change.

If you have never used an AI, start with «Start here» and go in order. If you use them already, go straight to what you need: each section ends with what is worth knowing once you have some practice.

FOUR WORDS BEFORE YOU START

Agent

An AI that works on your project. Codex, Claude and Gemini are agents.

Project

A folder on your Mac. Each one has its chats and its memory.

Permission

What the agent may do with that message: only talk, create files or change them.

Memory

What MADRE remembers about your project, so you do not have to explain it every time.

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01

Start here

One command installs MADRE and opens it in your browser. There, the welcome gets everything ready step by step. After that you do not need the terminal (the window where you type commands). No account, no card.

Mac

1. Install Node 22.5 or newer from nodejs.org, or with `brew install node`. If you have it, skip this step.
2. Open the Terminal app (find it with Spotlight) and paste the command.

```
$ npx @jossuealcala/madre
```

For AI on your computer, the welcome gives you the link to the official Ollama app.

Linux

1. Install Node 22.5 or newer from nodejs.org or with nvm: the one in your system's packages may be older.
2. Open your terminal and paste the command.

```
$ npx @jossuealcala/madre
```

To install Ollama, Linux asks for your password. The welcome gives you the line to copy: MADRE never asks for passwords or keeps them.

Windows, with WSL2

On Windows, MADRE runs inside WSL2, the Linux that comes with Windows 10 and 11. Opened on Windows itself, it explains these steps and stops.

1. Once, in PowerShell as administrator, type `wsl --install` and restart.
2. Open «Ubuntu» from the Start menu and install Node 22: `curl -fsSL https://deb.nodesource.com/setup_22.x | sudo -E bash -` and then `sudo apt install -y nodejs`.
3. Paste the command in Ubuntu. MADRE opens in your Windows browser.

```
$ npx @jossuealcala/madre
```

Keep your projects inside Linux (in /home), not in /mnt/c: there MADRE is faster and protects your files better.

Another computer (SSH) or a virtual machine

If MADRE runs on a server or in a virtual machine you reach over SSH, your browser is on your own computer and reaches MADRE through a tunnel.

1. On the server, paste MADRE's command. The terminal writes the tunnel command for you, with your user, your server and the port.
2. On your own computer, open another terminal, paste that command and leave it open.
3. Open http://127.0.0.1:5317/salas in your browser.

```
$ npx @jossuealcala/madre
```

In a virtual machine, AI on your computer is slow. If your PC runs Windows, MADRE works better with WSL than in a virtual machine.

1. MADRE opens in your browser with the welcome. Choose your language and follow the seven steps.
2. If something fails, the welcome tells you what happened, and «See how to fix it» gives you the steps for your system.
3. To come back another day, use the same command: Home opens, with your projects.

TRY IT

To know whether you have Node already, type `node --version` in the terminal. If it says v22.5 or a higher number, you are set.

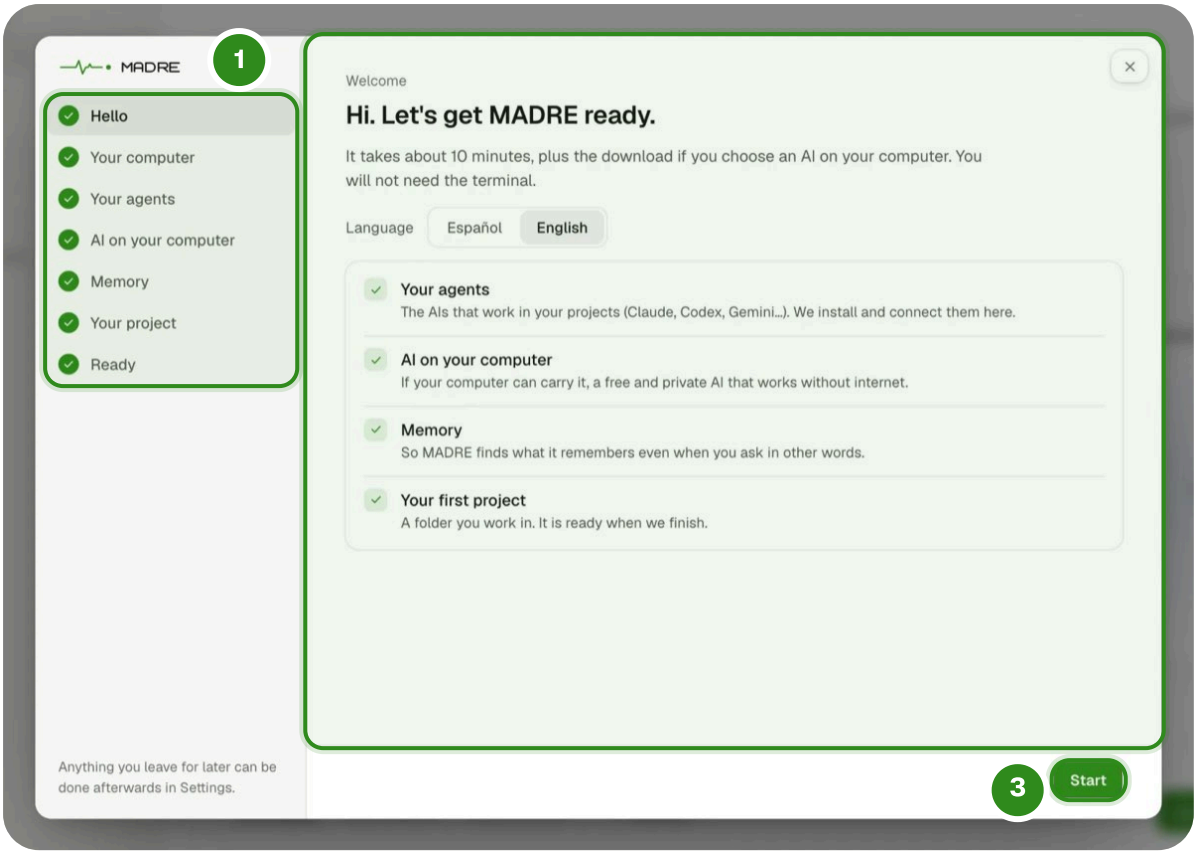
IF YOU KNOW THE BASICS

MADRE does not keep your passwords: it uses the sessions your agents already have on your Mac. With `--port 4800` it opens on another port.

02

The welcome

The first time, MADRE greets you with seven steps: your computer, your agents, AI on your computer, the memory and your first project. All with buttons, no terminal.



1. The seven steps are on the left. You can go to any of them; the ones you finish get a tick.
2. Each step tells you what it is and gives you the button to do it: connect an agent, download the AI or choose your folder.
3. «Continue» takes you to the next one. Whatever you leave for later can be done in Settings.

TRY IT

If you closed it, open it again: in Home, Settings › Projects › «See the welcome again».

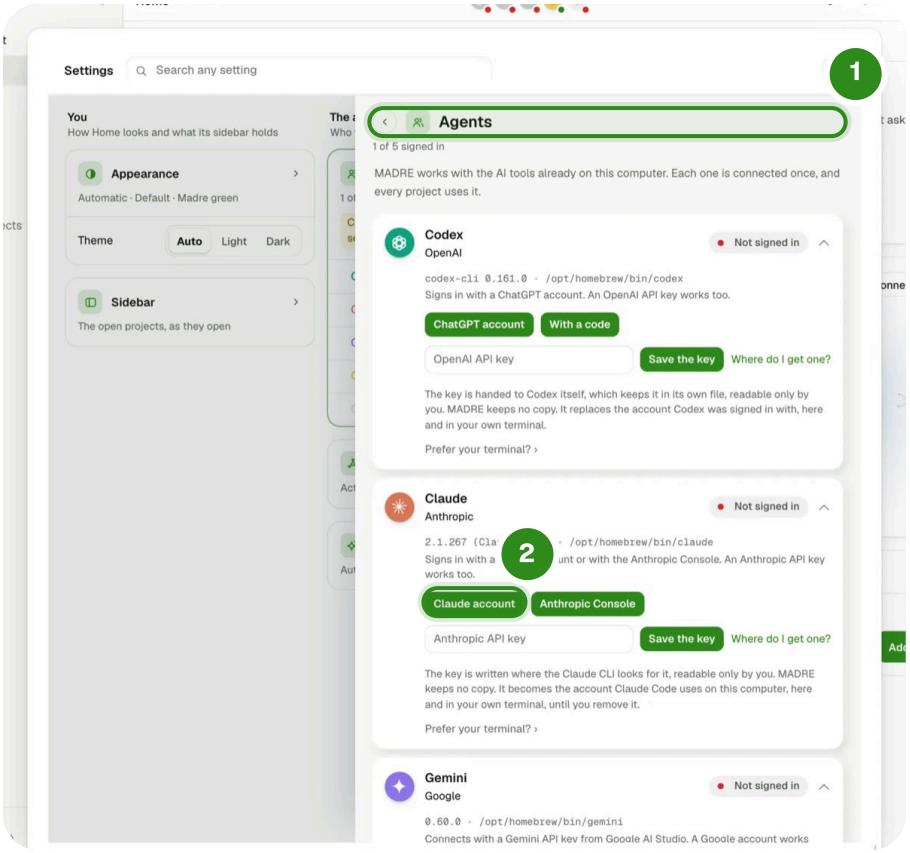
IF YOU KNOW THE BASICS

The welcome remembers the step you were on. If you used MADRE 1.0 before, Home shows you what is new in 1.1 first.

03

Connect your agents

An agent is an AI such as Codex, Claude or Gemini. You connect it once and every project uses it. One is enough to start.



1. In Home, open Settings (the gear, bottom left) › Agents. The first time, the welcome takes you there.
2. Open an agent that says «Not signed in» and press its button, such as «Claude account». You sign in with your account on the provider's page. If you do not have it, you will see Install.
3. Once it says «Connected», you can talk to it.

TRY IT

If you already use ChatGPT, connect Codex with that same account: it is the quickest.

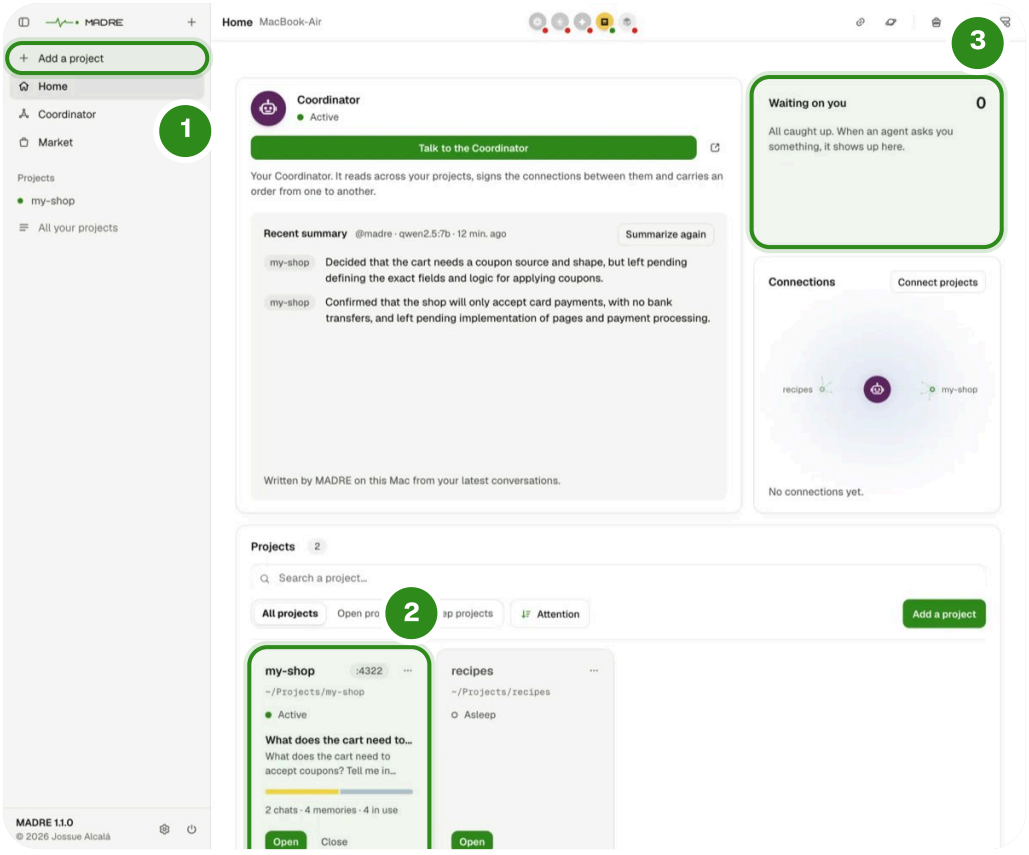
IF YOU KNOW THE BASICS

Each agent keeps its own session; MADRE does not read it. Access keys (API keys) for Codex, Claude, Gemini and OpenCode go in the same card, and «Prefer your terminal?» gives you the command. If MADRE runs on another computer, Codex connects «With a code».

04

Home and your projects

Home is the first thing you see when you open MADRE: your projects, the Coordinator and what is waiting for you. A project is a folder on your Mac; adding it changes nothing inside it.



1. In the left column, press «Add a project» and choose the folder.
2. It shows up under Projects. Press Open on its card to go in.
3. «Waiting on you» gathers what was left open: a question from an agent, a permission or a reminder.

TRY IT

If you have no folder at hand, create an empty one called «test» and add it.

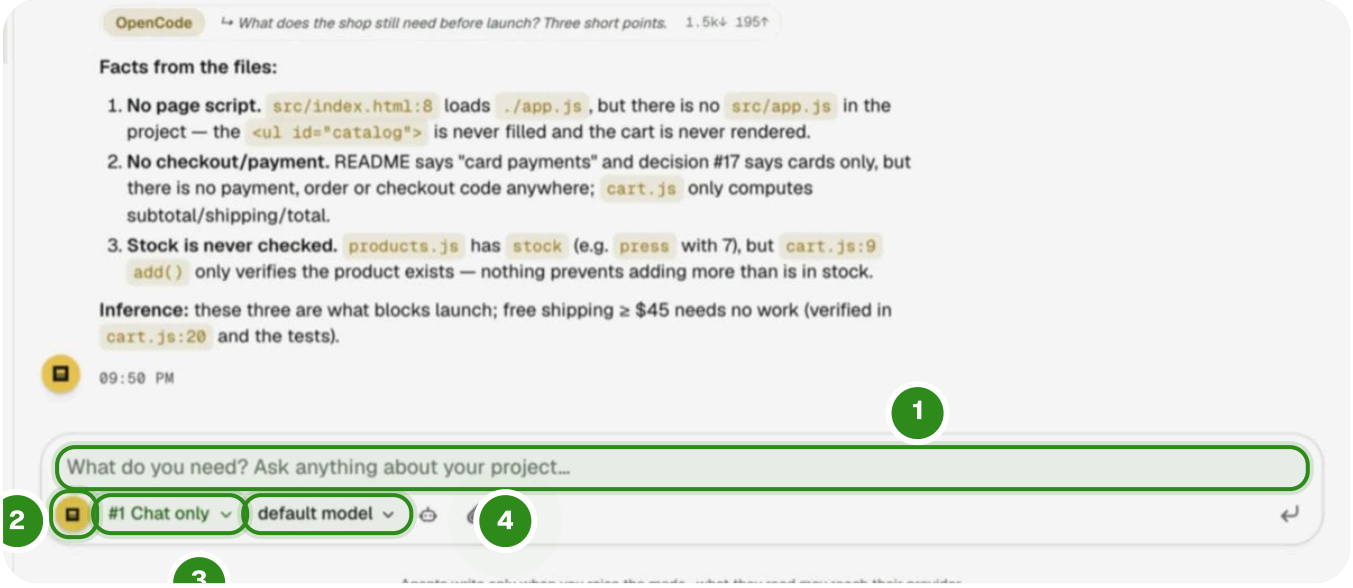
IF YOU KNOW THE BASICS

The left column is the same in Home and in every project: Home, the Coordinator, the Market and your open projects. «Attention» puts first the projects with something waiting. The ··· menu of a card takes it out of MADRE; your folder stays as it is.

05

Ask an agent for something

You type at the bottom and the agent answers in the chat. You do not need to know about AI: ask the way you would ask a person.



1. Type in the box and press ↵ to send.
2. The circle on the left is the agent that will answer. Tap it to choose another.
3. The tag with # is the permission. With #1 the agent reads and answers you, but changes nothing.
4. Beside it you choose the model and, for some agents, how much it thinks. If you are not sure, leave it.

TRY IT

Type: Explain what this project does in five lines.

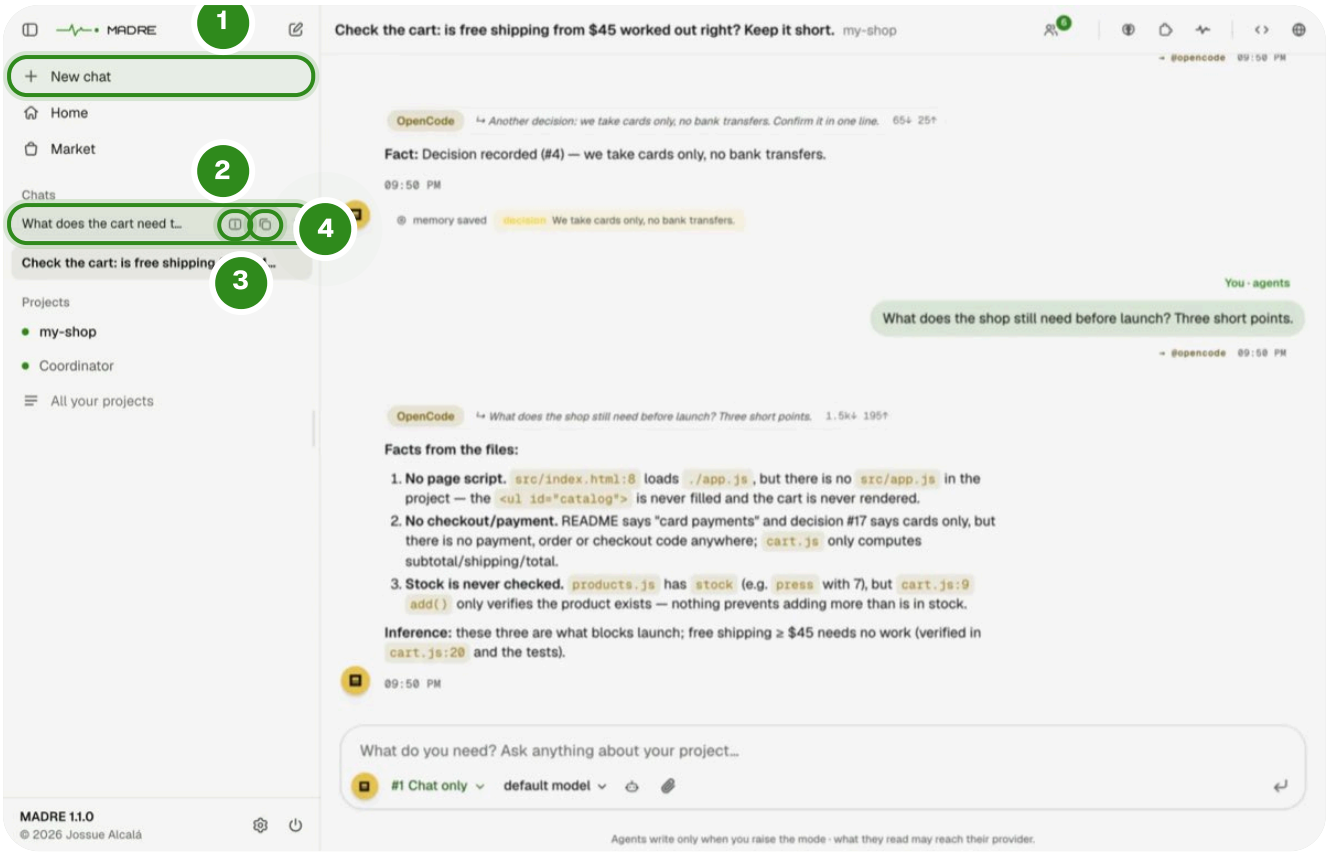
IF YOU KNOW THE BASICS

@ calls an agent, # changes the permission, ! quotes a file and / opens the commands. ⌥ ↵ adds a line break and ⌘ V pastes an image.

06

Your chats

Each project keeps its chats in the left column. They all share the project's memory: what was decided in one, the agent knows in another.



1. «New chat» starts a conversation.
2. Your chats stay below it, the latest on top. Click one to go back to it.
3. Hover over a chat: the first button opens it beside, in the other half of the window.
4. The second opens it in its own window, which you can move. The × deletes it.

TRY IT

Open a new chat and ask about something you decided in another chat.

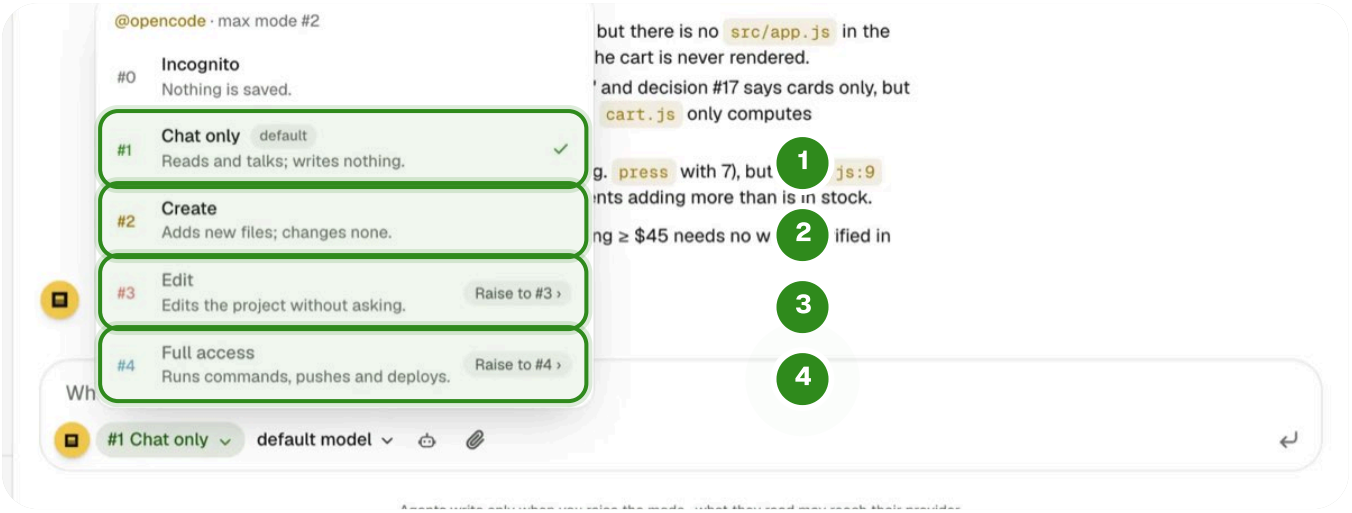
IF YOU KNOW THE BASICS

The key at the top left hides the column to give you more room; in a narrow window, the column opens over the conversation. Under Projects, at the bottom, you jump to another open project without going through Home.

07

How far it can go

Every message carries a permission. Start with #1, which changes nothing, and raise it when you want the agent to work on your files.



1. #1 Chat only: reads your project and answers you.
2. #2 Create: adds new files.
3. #3 Edit: changes your files. It asks you to confirm, and MADRE keeps a point to undo.
4. #4 Full access: runs commands and may publish. It asks you to confirm twice.

TRY IT

With #2 ask: `create a todo.md file with what is left`. The new file appears; the files you had are not touched.

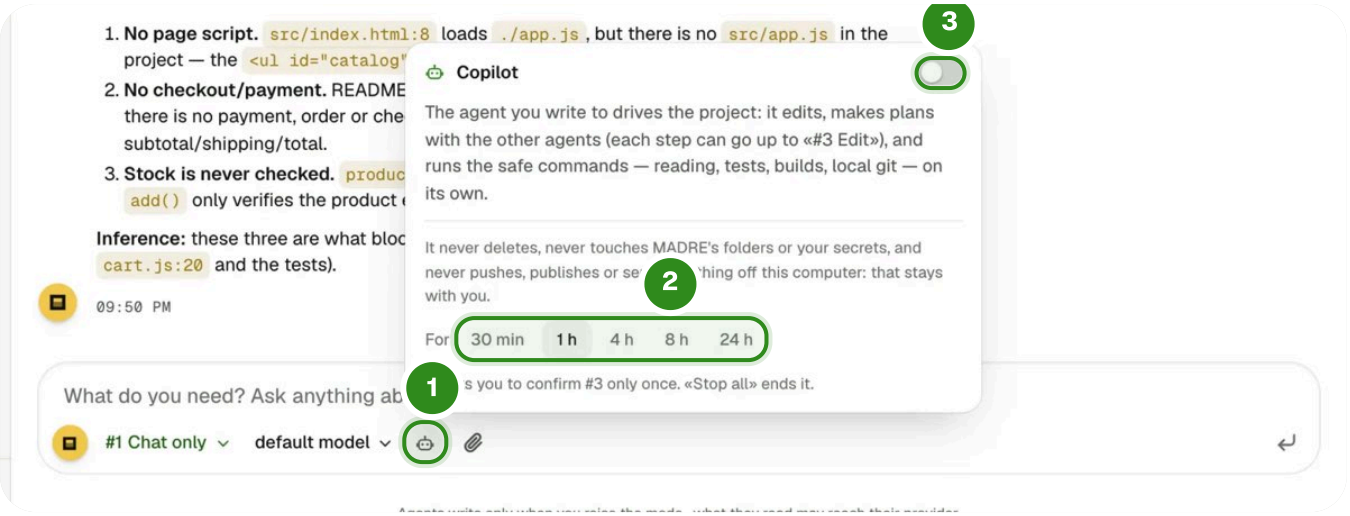
IF YOU KNOW THE BASICS

#0 Incognito talks without keeping anything. You can leave #3 or #4 open for longer, to work without interruptions. Each agent's ceiling and how you confirm are in Settings › Permissions.

08

Let it work on its own for a while

For a long job, Copilot lets the agent move on without asking your permission at every step.



1. Press the robot beside the box.
2. Choose for how long: from 30 minutes to 24 hours.
3. Turn it on and write the task. It asks you to confirm only once.

TRY IT

Turn it on for an hour and ask: go through every test and fix the ones that fail.

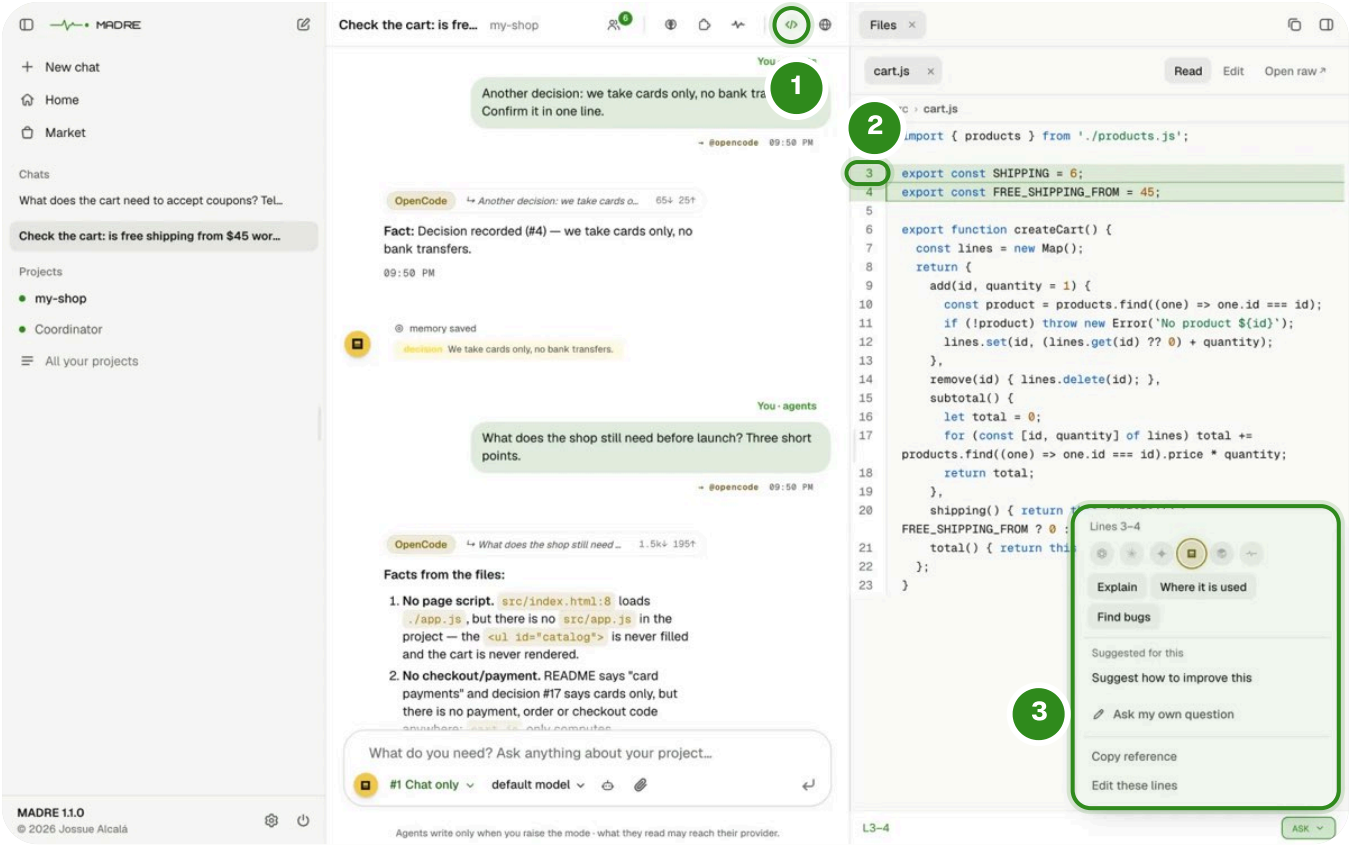
IF YOU KNOW THE BASICS

With Copilot the agent edits and runs what is safe, such as your tests. It never deletes or publishes. It turns itself off when the time is up, or with «Stop all».

09

Your files

Files opens your project to the right of the chat. What each agent changed is marked in its color.



1. Press Files (</>) in the bar at the top and open a file from the list.
2. Click the number of a line. With ⇧ you choose several.
3. Press ASK: choose the agent and what you want, or copy the reference to quote it in the chat.

TRY IT

Open a file, click the number of a line and press ASK › Explain.

IF YOU KNOW THE BASICS

⌘ P finds a file by its name. Edit lets you type: ⌘ S saves, ⌘ F searches and ⌘ / comments. If you close a file with unsaved changes, they stay in its tab.

10

The memory

MADRE remembers what is decided in your project, so you do not have to explain it every time. All your agents read the same memory.



1. Press Memory map in the bar. Type the project's name and it opens full screen.
2. Each dot is something MADRE remembers. Its color says whether it is a decision, a fact or a preference.
3. Click one to read it. If it is no longer true, you forget it from there.

TRY IT

Tell one agent: `note this: prices always include tax`. Then ask another agent about prices.

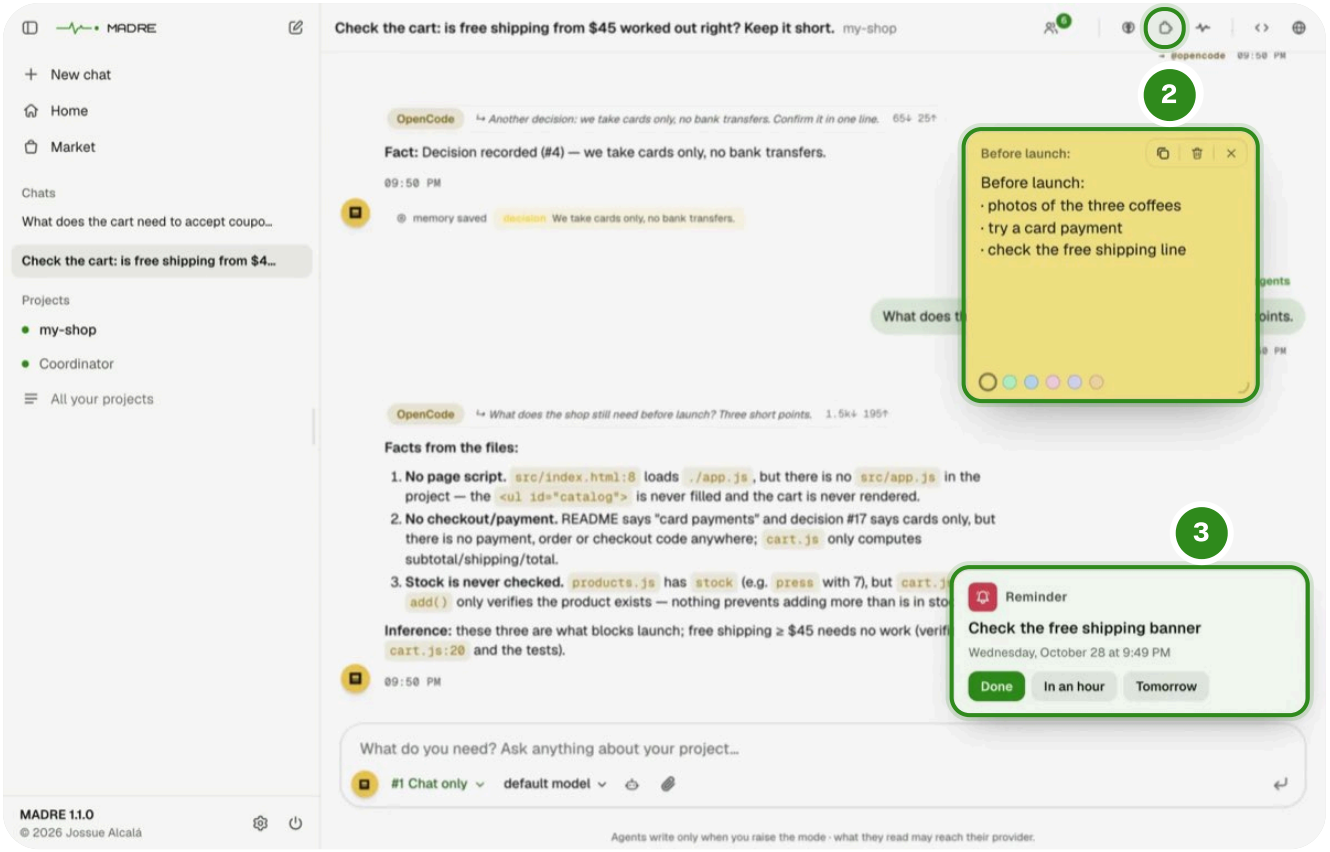
IF YOU KNOW THE BASICS

Neural, at the top right, draws the same map as neurons. With #0 Incognito nothing is kept. With local AI, the memory is searched by what it means, not only by its words.

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Notes and reminders

A note is a colored sticky note on your project. A reminder tells you on the day and at the time you say.



1. Turn on Notes and Reminders in Modules, in the bar at the top.
2. Each note opens its window: write, change its color or throw it away.
3. When a reminder's time comes, MADRE shows it in the project and in «Waiting on you», in Home: «Done», «In an hour» or «Tomorrow».

TRY IT

Write to an agent: remind me tomorrow at 10 to check the banner.

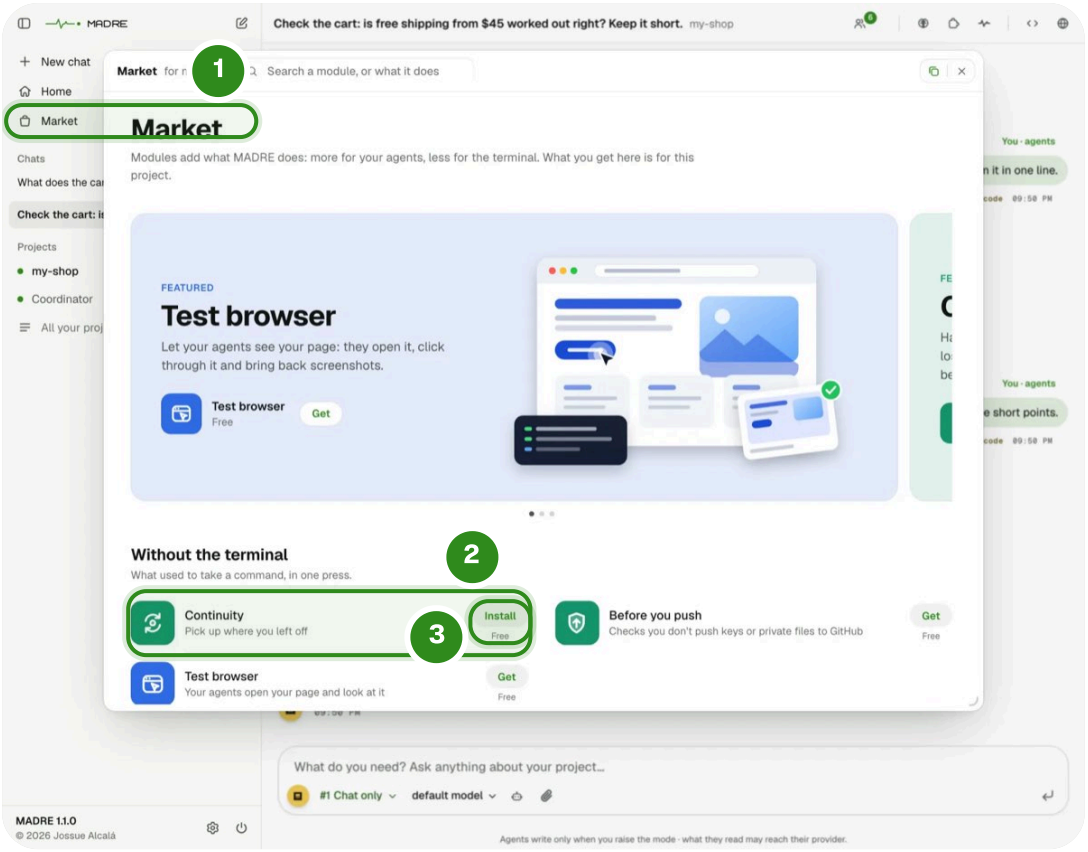
IF YOU KNOW THE BASICS

/notes and /reminders ask the agent you have chosen for the note or the reminder. If you write «I have to…», MADRE offers to keep it.

12

The Market and your modules

The Market adds features to MADRE: Notes, Reminders, Preview, Before you push and more. Every module tells you what it does before you install it.



1. Press Market in the left column.
2. Tap a module to read what it does, what it touches in your project and who made it.
3. Press Get or Install. Afterwards you turn it on or off in Modules, in the project's bar.

TRY IT

Find «Before you push» and get it: before your code goes to GitHub, it checks that no keys or private files go with it.

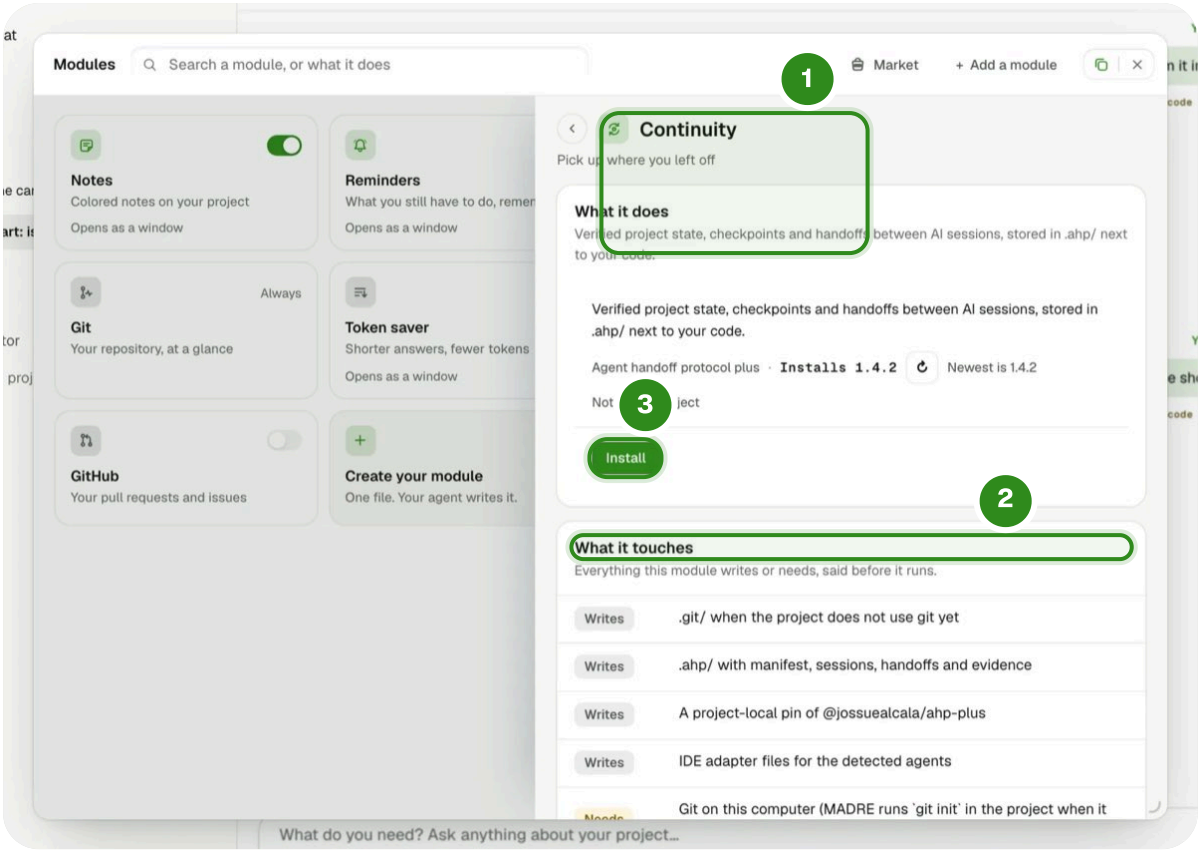
IF YOU KNOW THE BASICS

What you get in a project's Market is for that project. Community modules say who made them and their license; MADRE checks their signature before installing them.

13

Continuity

Continuity keeps, inside your project, where the work stands: decisions, what is pending and points to undo. If you switch agent, editor or computer, the next one picks up from there.



1. In Modules, tap Continuity.
2. «What it touches» shows what it writes: a .ahp/ folder inside your project, in plain text.
3. Press Install. Your project needs to use git, with at least one commit.

TRY IT

Install it, work for a while with Codex, then open the project in Claude Code, outside MADRE: it already knows where you were.

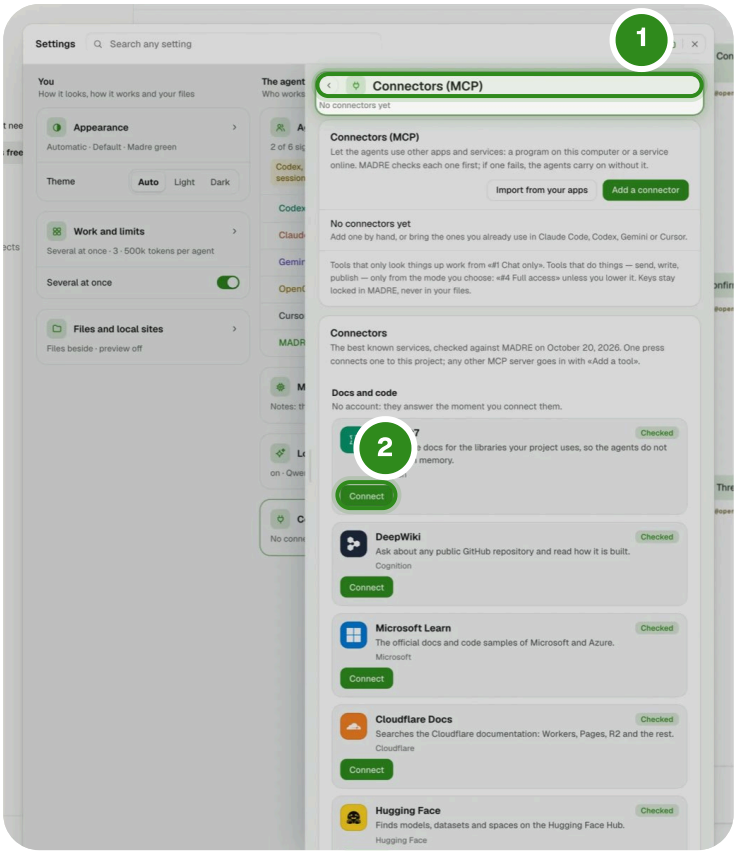
IF YOU KNOW THE BASICS

Outside MADRE it is called AHP+. Claude Code, Codex and OpenCode read it with their own files, and it travels with your repository.

14

Connectors (MCP)

A connector lets your agents use another app, such as GitHub, Notion or your calendar.



1. Open Settings › Connectors (MCP).
2. Choose one from the catalog and press Connect. Some open their page so you can sign in.
3. Press «Check the connection» to confirm it answers.

TRY IT

Connect GitHub and ask: which issues do I have open?.

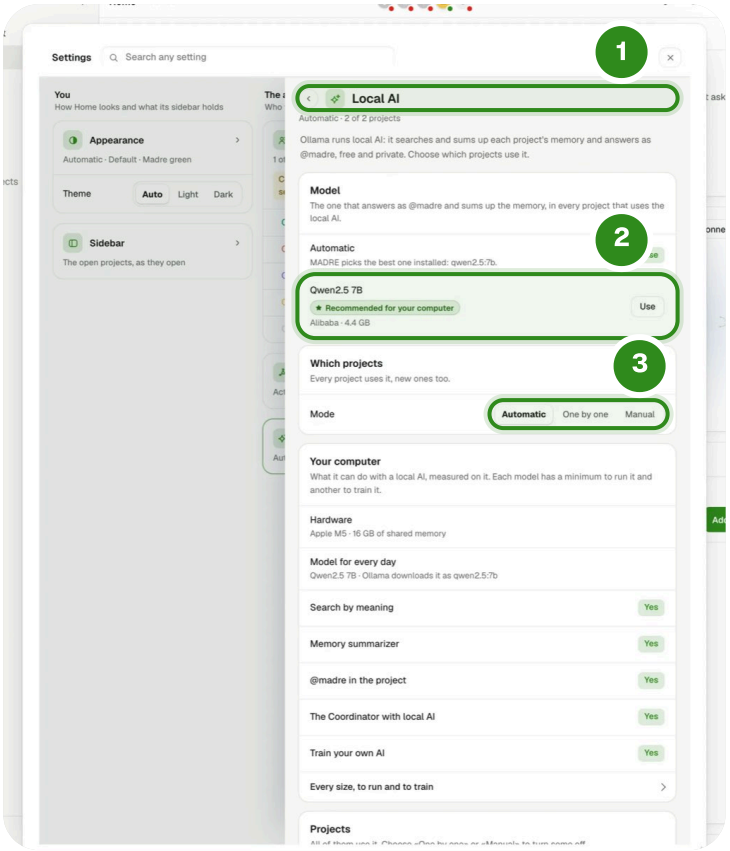
IF YOU KNOW THE BASICS

If you already set them up in Claude Code, Codex, Gemini or Cursor, «Import from your apps» brings them in.

15

AI on your Mac

An AI that runs on your machine, free and offline. MADRE uses it to keep the memory in order and as one more agent: @madre.



1. In Home, open Settings › Local AI.
2. Download the model marked «Recommended for your computer»: it is already sized for your Mac.
3. Choose which projects use it.

TRY IT

Download the recommended model and ask @madre something about your project.

IF YOU KNOW THE BASICS

It runs on Ollama. MADRE only offers the models that fit your machine. If another computer on your network has Ollama and a graphics card (or, from WSL, Windows' own), type its address in «Ollama address».

16

Train your AI

You teach @madre with what your project knows. It all happens on your computer: you export, train a small model and Ollama runs it.

1. Open Settings › Memory › Train your own AI and press Export. Paths, names, emails and keys are covered, and nothing from #0 Incognito goes in.
2. Open Step by step: MADRE measures your machine, suggests the size and gives you each command with your folders.
3. When it is done, in Settings › Local AI press Check again: @madre now answers with your model.

TRY IT

Export and see how many examples your project already has.

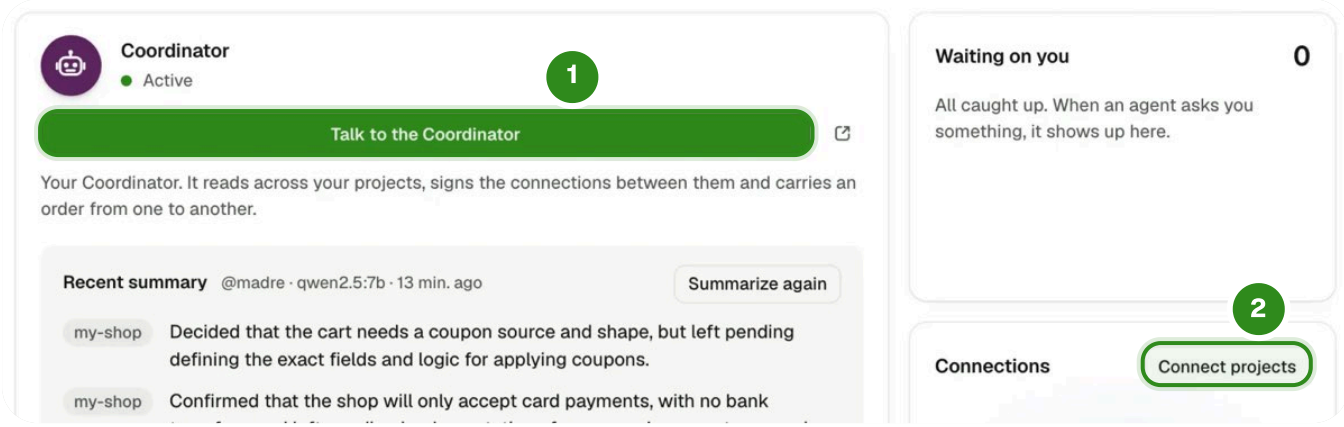
IF YOU KNOW THE BASICS

It works on a Mac with an Apple chip; on Linux with an NVIDIA card, or on Windows inside WSL with its NVIDIA card, it is a trial. With about 200 examples it learns the tone; from 1000 it is worth it. Before you trust it, ask it ten things the project decided and five that were never discussed.

17

Several projects at once

The Coordinator sees all your projects. With a connection, one project can look up what another one learned.



1. In Home, press «Talk to the Coordinator».
2. Press «Connect projects» and choose two. You decide what it may look up and until when.

TRY IT

In Home, ask the Coordinator: which project was I on yesterday?.

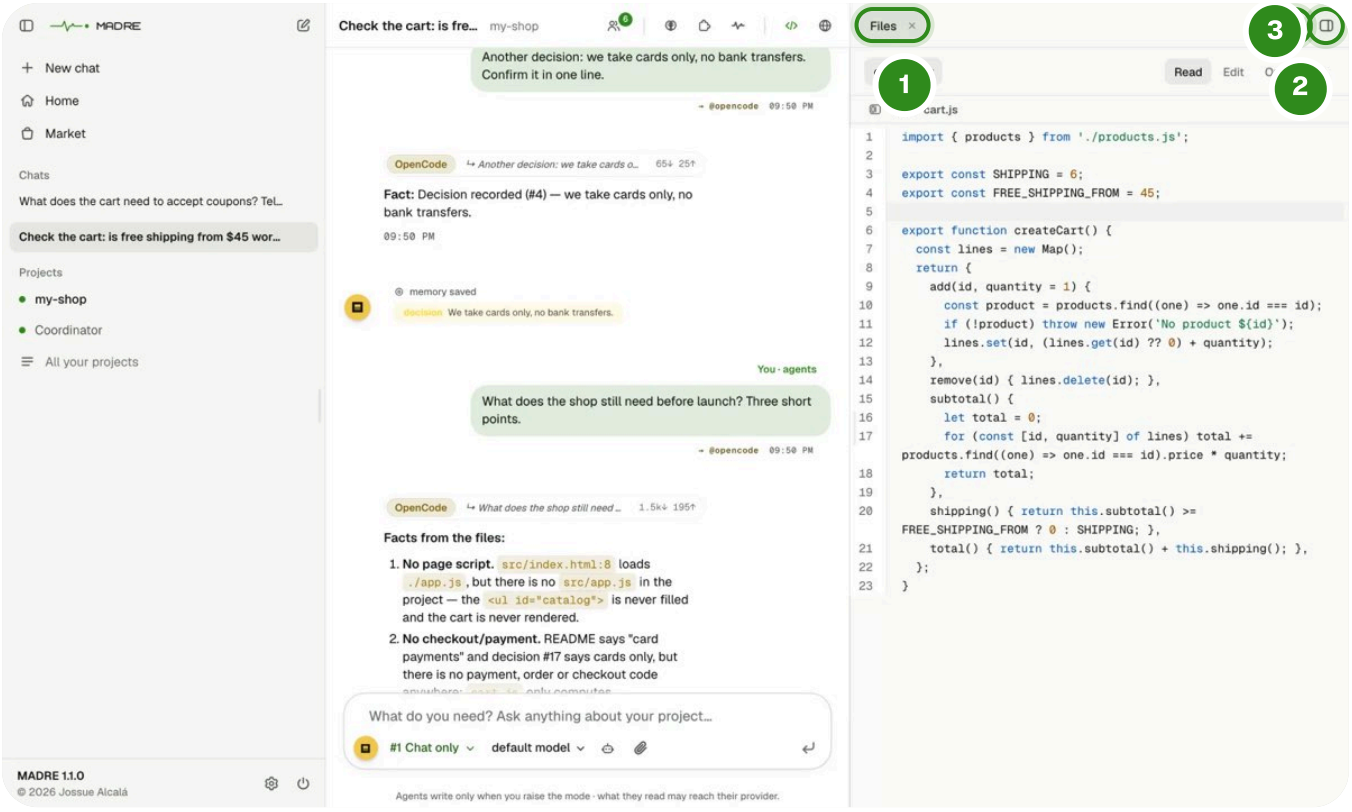
IF YOU KNOW THE BASICS

From any project you ask it with /bishop. Memory notes travel through a connection, never your files or your chats.

18

The right column and windows

Files, Your servers and the other tools open to the right of the chat, each in its tab. Any of them can come out as a window you move around, as on your Mac.



1. Each open tool is a tab. The tab's ✕ closes it.
2. The window button takes it out of the column, to put it wherever you like.
3. The last button closes the whole column.

TRY IT

Open Files and press the window button: Files floats over the chat. Another click puts it back.

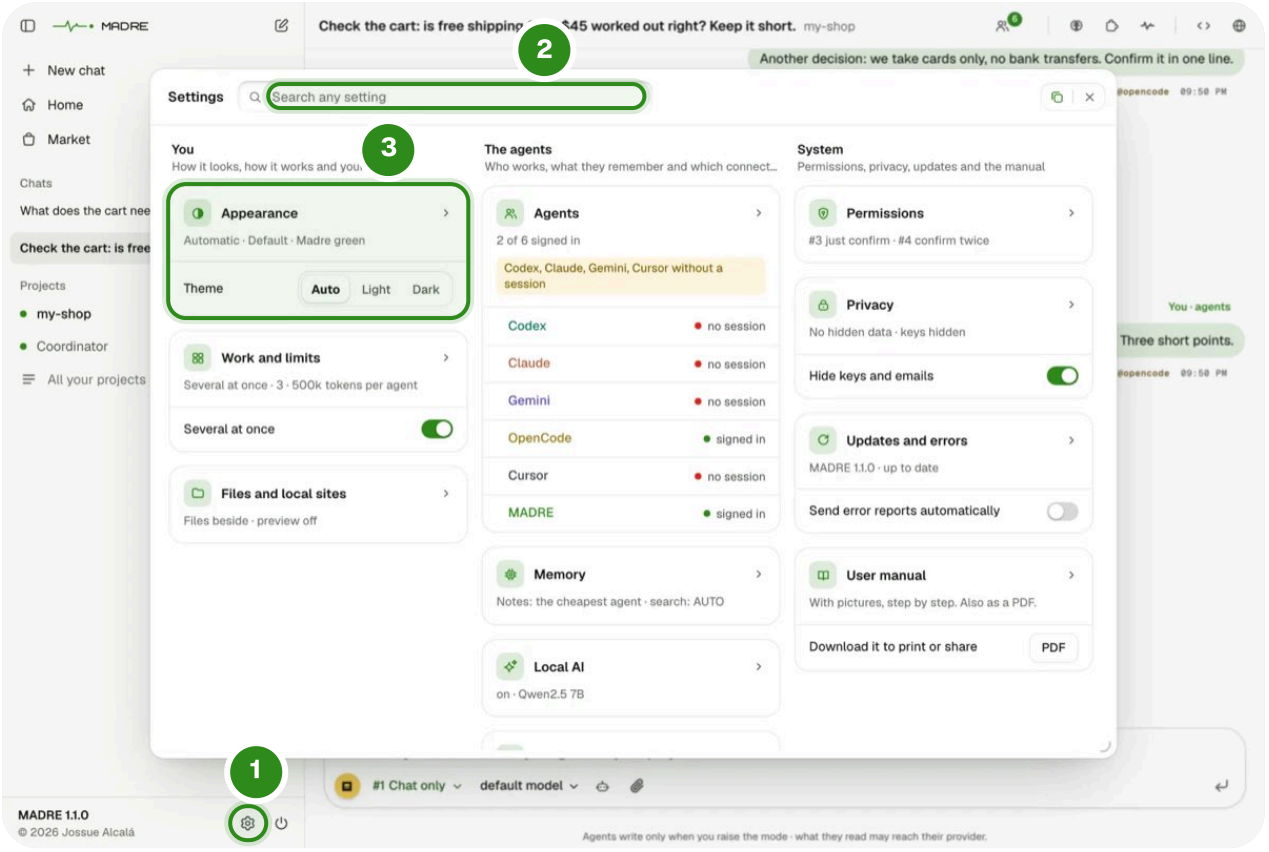
IF YOU KNOW THE BASICS

Rest the pointer on a window's window button: it offers half, quarter or full screen. If your browser window gets narrow, whatever no longer fits beside the chat becomes a window on its own.

19

Settings

Agents, permissions, appearance, memory and privacy are changed here.



1. Open them with the gear in the left column or with ⌘ ,.
2. Find any setting by its name.
3. Each card says how it is set before you open it. What you change saves itself.

TRY IT

Type «accent» in the search box and try another color.

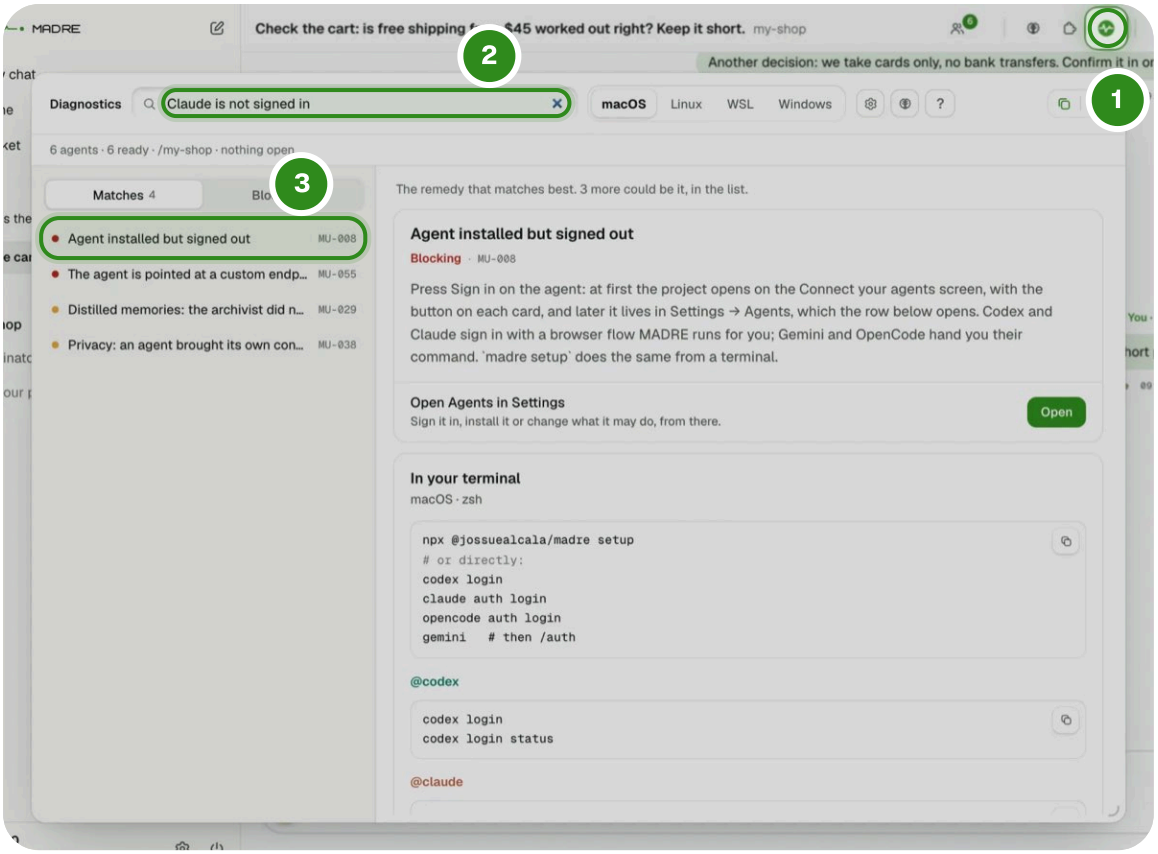
IF YOU KNOW THE BASICS

Each project can have its own color. In Updates and errors you see what the anonymous diagnostics would send, and turn them off there.

20

When something does not work

Diagnostics checks what is going on and gives you the button to fix it, without leaving the project.



1. Press Diagnostics in the bar.
2. Type what you see, in your own words.
3. Open the case that looks like yours and follow what it says.

TRY IT

If an agent asks you to sign in, open Diagnostics and type `Claude is not signed in`.

IF YOU KNOW THE BASICS

At the top you choose your system (macOS, Linux, WSL or Windows) and the commands change with it. ? opens every shortcut on any screen.

21

Common problems

What happens most often and how to fix it. If yours is not here, open Diagnostics and type what you see.

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
An agent says «Not signed in».	Settings › Agents: open it and press its button to sign in with your account.
MADRE does not find an agent.	Settings › Agents › Install. MADRE runs the command for you.
Gemini says it hit its limit (429) or is overloaded (503).	Wait a minute and ask again, choose another model in the model menu, or pass the question to another agent.
Gemini turns down your personal Google account.	Paste an access key (API key) from Google AI Studio in Settings › Agents › Gemini.
Cursor says it reached its plan's limit.	It is your Cursor plan's limit, not MADRE's. Wait for it to renew or ask another agent.
«The API account ran out of credit».	Top up that account or, in Settings › Agents, choose a model that uses your plan, such as ChatGPT or GitHub Copilot.
The agent did not answer in time.	Ask again. If it happens often, raise the time limit in Settings › Work and limits.
«The port is already in use».	Another MADRE is open: use that one, or open this one on another port with `npx @jossuealcala/madre --port 4800`.
The Terminal says your Node is too old.	Install Node 22.5 or newer from nodejs.org and run the command again.
You opened MADRE on Windows and it says it stops.	On Windows, MADRE runs inside WSL2. Follow «Windows, with WSL2» in «Start here».

In WSL, Windows' local AI does not answer.	In the Ollama app on Windows, turn on «Expose Ollama to the network». Then, in Settings › Local AI, type the address MADRE suggests.
The browser did not open.	Open the address the terminal printed (it ends in /salas). In WSL, open it in your Windows browser with localhost.
You came in over SSH and the page does not load.	On your own computer, open the tunnel the terminal printed, with 127.0.0.1 and not localhost, and leave it open.
An answer stopped because MADRE restarted.	Ask again. The chat was not lost.

IF YOU KNOW THE BASICS

Diagnostics works from the Terminal too: `npx @jossuealcala/madre doctor`.

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The license, in short

MADRE uses the Business Source License 1.1. Its code is public: you may read it, change it and share it.

1. It is free for individuals and for organizations of up to 10 people, also when you use MADRE to provide services to others, for example as a freelancer or an agency.
2. A larger organization, or anyone who wants to offer MADRE to others as a service, needs a commercial license: write to hola@jossuealcala.com.
3. Each version moves to the free GNU AGPL v3 license four years after it is published.

IF YOU KNOW THE BASICS

Versions 1.0.2 to 1.0.5 stay under the GNU AGPL v3. The full text is in the LICENSE file and, inside MADRE, in Settings › Updates and errors › The license.

23

Every shortcut

Everywhere in MADRE

Settings

`⌘ ,`

Close what is on top, layer by layer

`Esc`

Stop everything

`/stopall`

Another tab when going to a project

`⌘ click`

This sheet

`?`

The bar

Order it

`right-click`

Remove a key

`-`

Move a key

`drag`

What does not fit

`•••`

Switch project

Open the panel

`click`

Move through it

`← → ↑ ↓`

Go

`click or ↵`

Close it

`Esc`

Windows and panels

Move

`drag the header`

ARRANGE

`hold the pointer 0.4 s`

All aside, or all back

`click the desktop`

Move aside what covers

`click or type`

Bring one back

`click its edge`

Panel width

`← → · ⇧ for 64 px`

The box

Send

`↵`

New line

`⌥ ↵`

Agent, mode, file, command

`@ # ! /`

Paste or drop images

`⌘ V`

Code

Find a file

`⌘ P`

Save

`⌘ S`

Find in the file

`⌘ F`

Comment the lines

`⌘ /`

Settings

Search

`/`

Open the first

`↵`

Back, layer by layer

`Esc`

Memory map

Turn

`drag`

Move

`⇧ drag`

Zoom

`wheel`

Read a memory

`click`

Project map

Move the space

`drag`

Go to one

`click · ← →`

Connect two

`carry one onto another`

Back

`Esc, layer by layer`

Home

A card's menu

`right-click`

Move a card

`drag`

Add cards and widgets

`right-click the background`

A project's menu

`right-click · ⋯`

Pin it

`drag to the bar`

Those that do not fit

`+n`

Viewer and editor

Save

`⌘ S`

Find · replace

`⌘ F · ⌥ ⌘ F`

Go to a line

`^ G`

MADRE is free for individuals and teams of up to 10 (BSL 1.1 license). Help and news at madre.run.

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